ROAD BIKES · 5 MIN READ

Race, aero, endurance, gravel: telling them apart

Every drop-bar bike on our floor is built for one kind of riding. Before you talk price, find out how the customer rides. Then you know which shelf to walk to.

TYPE	POSITION	BUILT FOR	IN OUR RANGE
Race all-rounder	Low and long	Climbing, fast group rides, racing	Merida Scultura, Cannondale SuperSix EVO, Pinarello F, Argon 18 Sum
Aero	Low and long, deep tube shapes	Speed on flat roads, racing	Trek Madone, Merida Reacto, Look 795 Blade
Endurance	Taller front, shorter reach	Long days, rough roads, first road bike	Trek Domane, Cannondale Synapse, Merida Scultura Endurance, Pinarello X, Look 765 Optimum, Giant Contend AR, Ridley Fenix, Argon 18 Krypton
Gravel	Upright, tyres of 38 mm and wider	Broken roads, trails, bikepacking	Trek Checkpoint, Cannondale Topstone, Kona Rove and Libre
Touring	Upright, rack mounts everywhere	Loaded long-distance travel	Kona Sutra, Marin Four Corners

Stack and reach

Two numbers explain the position. **Stack** is how tall the front of the bike is. **Reach** is how far forward the rider stretches. An endurance bike has more stack and less reach, so the rider sits more upright with less load on the back, neck and hands. A race bike has less stack and more reach, so the rider is lower and more aerodynamic.

Things to know about our range

- The current Trek Madone (Gen 8) replaced both the older Madone and the Émonda. It is Trek's one race bike now: aero and light together.
- Pinarello uses letters: **F** models are race bikes, **X** models are endurance bikes.
- Merida has three road families: **Reacto** (aero), **Scultura** (light race), **Scultura Endurance** (comfort).
- Gravel bikes look like road bikes but take much wider tyres. Do not sell a race bike to someone who wants to ride dirt roads.

On the shop floor

For a first road bike or a weekend rider doing 50 to 100 km, start with endurance. Move to race or aero only when the customer talks about racing, fast group rides, or already rides in a low position comfortably.

Remember these

- Ask how they ride before you ask the budget.
- Endurance means more stack and less reach: a more upright, comfortable position.
- Madone and Reacto are aero. Domane, Synapse and Scultura Endurance are endurance.
- Gravel and touring bikes are for rough roads and loads, not for speed on tarmac.